

Your Binding Constraint: **Conversion**

Leads come in but don't convert. You're losing revenue between inquiry and close. Here's how to fix it.

How This Shows Up

You're spending on leads but revenue isn't growing. Close rate below 30%. Leads go dark after the first call. The owner or one person closes everything.

How It Plays Out by Industry

HVAC: Widest close rate range (30-42%). Biggest killer: slow response time. Leads contacted within 5 min are 21× more likely to qualify.

Plumbing: Highest close rate (41.5%) but only 27-31% of phone leads are ever contacted.

Electrical: High close rate (43.4%) but the problem is upsell — a \$150 outlet call should become a \$4,000 panel upgrade.

The Most Common Mistakes

1. Slow response time (industry avg: 14+ hours)
2. No follow-up on unsold estimates (top shops recover 11-15% of revenue here)
3. The owner is the only closer
4. No contact tracking
5. Pricing conversations happen too early

The Fix: Step by Step

Step 1: Measure speed-to-lead — timestamp every inbound lead for one week.

Step 2: Automate the first response — auto-responders double contact rate.

Step 3: Build a follow-up sequence — Day 1 email, Day 3 text, Day 7 call, Day 14 final email.

Step 4: Train someone else to close — record your best calls, have them shadow, then take 20% of calls.

Step 5: Track contact rate and close rate by source monthly.

Do's and Don'ts

Do: Respond within 5 minutes. Follow up on every unsold estimate 3×. Record and review sales calls weekly. Track close rate by source. Train at least one other closer.

Don't: Let leads sit for hours. Send one estimate and hope. Give pricing before establishing value. Let the owner be the only closer.

Want the full 6-Vector Roadmap?

This guide covers one constraint. A Growth Blocker Analysis covers all six — I pressure-test your scores against 400+ service business benchmarks and give you a complete growth roadmap in 30 minutes.

[Book a Growth Blocker Analysis →](#)